



THE BEHEMOTH'S FOOTPRINT

S. N. Subrahmanyam has transformed L&T by focusing on new technologies, long-term planning and early moves in areas such as semiconductors and green energy

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HINK LARSEN & TOUBRO (L&T) and what comes to mind are large projects. But that is a relatively simplistic way of summing up a conglomerate with multiple businesses. S.N. Subrahmanyam, its Chairman & Managing Director, says L&T is best described as a “tech company.”

“This is the path we are on. The story is all about engineering and technology. While we do projects, we are fundamentally into technology and will go wherever it leads us,” says Subrahmanyam.

Today, L&T operates in infrastructure projects, energy projects, hi-tech manufacturing, IT & technology services, financial services and development projects. What joins these diverse businesses is one word—technology, which is something Subrahmanyam is looking to bolster across verticals.

BREAKING IT DOWN

L&T is a complex conglomerate with a maze of businesses. “Projects are still a big part of what we do and that includes construction of infrastructure projects. Energy is also big,” says Subrahmanyam. There is also renewable energy. “Then, there is manufacturing, which is heavy engineering and precision engineering (defence),” he says. The services piece has IT and financial services.

Vipul Prasad, Founder & CEO, Magadh Capital Advisors, is impressed by diversification across old and new economy businesses. “That helps it tap opportunities in domestic and overseas markets. Such end-to-end capability at the scale at which L&T operates is difficult to replicate and gives it a significant advantage in winning complex, high-value orders,” he says.